

Real-Estate Data Import Kit — Guide

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A set of 8 connected spreadsheets your team fills in to describe every area, developer, project, unit type, unit, amenity and payment plan. Fill the sheets, hand them back, and they import cleanly into the database that powers the website. This guide explains how to use them. No technical background needed.

Arabic — يبرع

استيرادها بسهولة إلى قاعدة البيانات التي تشغل الموقع. هذا الدليل يشرح طريقة الاستخدام — بدون أي خبرة تقنية. يملؤها فريقك لوصف كل منطقة ومطور ومشروع ونوع وحدة ووحدة ومرفق ونظام سداد. املاً الجداول ثم أعدها، وسيتم مجموعة من 8 جداول مترابطة

What's in the box

File / folder	What it is
templates-xlsx/00_MASTER...	Read-Me + all drop-down lists + a full field index (start here).
templates-xlsx/01...08...	One Excel file per entity — the sheets your team fills in.
templates-csv/	Plain-CSV twins of every sheet (for direct/bulk import).
schema/schema.sql	Database tables (PostgreSQL) with keys, links and checks.
schema/schema.json	JSON-Schema for programmatic validation.
schema/validation_rules.json	Machine-readable rules the importer enforces.
docs/Data Dictionary.pdf	Every field of every sheet, explained (EN + AR).
docs/ER_Diagram.(png/svg/mmd)	Picture of how the 8 entities connect.
docs/ID_Strategy / Naming / ASSETS	How IDs, names and image folders work.
assets-structure/	Ready-made folders to drop your images/brochures into.

Fill the sheets in this order

Always enter a “parent” before the rows that point to it — a Project needs its Developer and Area to exist first.

#	Sheet	Depends on	One line
1	Areas	—	Geographic zones that projects belong to (e.g. New Cairo, North Coast).
2	Developers	—	Real-estate development companies whose projects you market.
3	Projects	Developers, Areas	Master developments (compounds / resorts) offered for primary sale.
4	Unit Types	Projects	Repeatable unit models/typologies within a project (e.g. 'Type A – 3BR').
5	Units	Projects (+ Unit Types, Plans)	Individual sellable units (inventory rows) inside a project.
6	Project Amenities	Projects	One row per amenity offered by a project (many amenities per project).
7	Payment Plans	Projects	Named payment structures offered on a project (down payment + tenor).

8	Developers & Projects Mapping	Developers, Projects	Bridge for projects co-developed by more than one company (joint ventures).
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The 10 golden rules

1. Each Excel file has 3 tabs: Template (type here) · Example (filled) (a sample) · Field Guide (every field explained).
2. Columns marked * are required. Hover a header (red triangle) to read its full help note.
3. Leave ID columns blank to auto-generate them, or keep the exact format shown (e.g. PRJ-00001) and never reuse a code.
4. To link rows, copy an ID exactly: a Project's developer_id must match a real Developer's developer_id.
5. Drop-down cells only accept a value from the list — pick, don't type.
6. Prices are illustrative and must be confirmed with the developer/advisor. We market PRIMARY sale only.
7. Dates are YYYY-MM-DD. Numbers have no commas or currency signs. Percent is the number only.
8. Images are entered as a file path (projects/badya/hero.jpg), never pasted pictures.
9. Separate multiple values with a pipe | (galleries, highlights).
10. Never rename tabs, delete the header row, or reorder columns.

How your data is checked (and error reports)

On import, every row is validated. Anything wrong is returned in an error report (CSV) so you can fix and re-submit — nothing half-imports.

Error code	Meaning
REQUIRED_MISSING	A required field is empty.
FK_NOT_FOUND	A linked ID doesn't exist in its parent sheet.
NOT_IN_LIST	Value isn't one of the allowed drop-down options.
DUPLICATE_ID	This ID/slug already exists.
SLUG_FORMAT	Slug must be lowercase-with-dashes.
BAD_NUMBER	Field must be a number (no commas/text).
BAD_DATE	Date must be YYYY-MM-DD.

The error report has columns: row_number, sheet, column, field, offending_value, severity, error_code, message. A ready template is in templates-csv/_import_error_report_TEMPLATE.csv.

IDs, names & images — quick reference

- IDs: fixed prefixes (AREA-, DEV-, PRJ-, UTP-, UNIT-, PAMN-, PLAN-, DPM-), zero-padded, permanent, unique. Blank = auto-generated. Full rules: docs/ID_Strategy.md.
- Slugs: lowercase-with-dashes, unique, permanent. Full rules: docs/Naming_Conventions.md.
- Images: a path inside assets/ (e.g. projects/badya/hero.jpg). Folders ready in assets-structure/. Full rules: docs/ASSETS_STRUCTURE.md.

Built to scale

The ID padding and database indexes are sized for 100,000+ units and millions of inventory rows without any format change. Import is done per sheet in the order above; large files can be split and imported in batches safely because links are by ID.